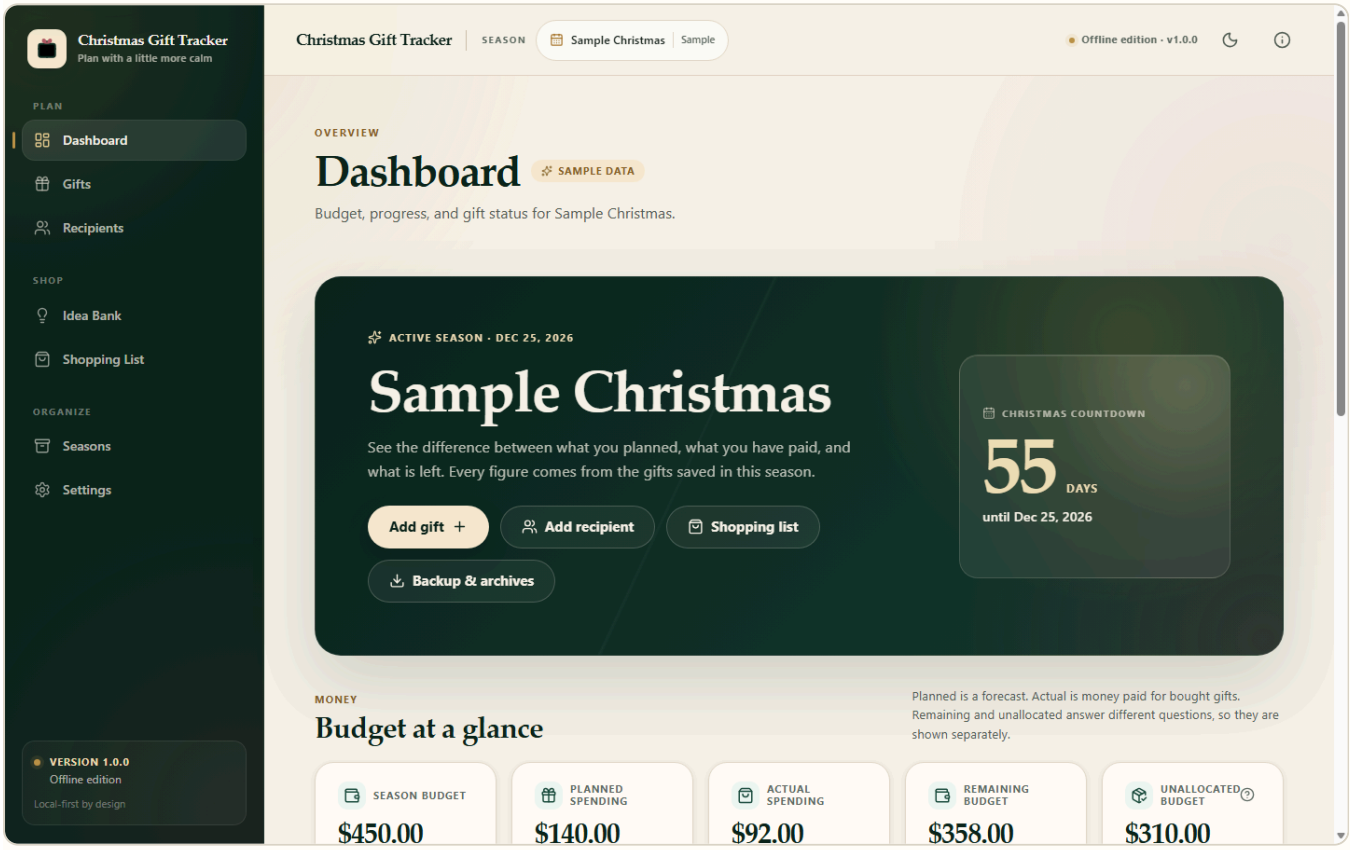
START HERE

# Christmas Gift Tracker

A calm, local-first planner for gifts, budgets, recipients, and ideas.

**Edition** Offline, account-free **Version** 1.0.0 **Guide updated** 31 October 2026

Thank you for choosing Christmas Gift Tracker. This short guide gets you from download to your first season in a few minutes. The full *User Guide* covers every screen, and *License and Support* explains terms and how to reach the seller.




The dashboard in the offline edition, using the included sample season.

## One thing to know first

This is an installable web app. You need an internet connection **once** to open and save the app. After that, it launches and works without a connection. The app is not opened from the downloaded folder, and it does not run from a file:// address.

## What is in your download

| Item | What it is for |
|---|---|
| **START-HERE.pdf** | This quick-start sheet. |
| **User-Guide.pdf** | Every feature, data safety, backups, and troubleshooting. |
| **License-and-Support.pdf** | Your license, privacy summary, support scope, and contact route. |
| **Sample-Data/Sample-Backup.json** | An optional example season with two recipients, three gifts, and two ideas. Restore it from **Seasons & archives > Backup and restore**. |
| **Offline-Edition/INSTALL.txt** | Short install notes you can keep next to the app. |

## Before you begin

- Use a current Chrome or Edge window on a computer for the most tested experience.
- Use a normal window, not private or incognito mode.
- Use the same browser and device each time.
- Keep your order confirmation or listing page nearby for the app link.

### Your data lives in this browser

Seasons, recipients, gifts, ideas, budgets, and notes are stored in this browser's local database. Clearing site data, resetting the browser profile, or using some cleanup tools can delete the planner. **Download a JSON backup regularly** from **Seasons & archives > Backup and restore**. There is no account and no cloud sync in this edition.

## Set up in four steps

### 1 Open the app link while online

Open the Christmas Gift Tracker address supplied with your purchase. Wait until the page finishes loading. The footer changes to **"Saved on this device"** when the local database is ready.

Optional: after a few seconds, a small banner may say **"Ready to work offline."** Choose **Got it**. This means the app has cached what it needs.

### 2 Install the app (recommended)

Installing gives the planner its own window and icon. It is optional.

- **Chrome or Edge on a computer:** use the install icon in the address bar, or the browser menu > *Install this site as an app*.
- **Android:** browser menu > *Install app* or *Add to Home screen*.
- **iPhone or iPad (Safari):** Share > *Add to Home Screen*.
- **Firefox on a computer:** no install is offered. Bookmark the page; offline use still works after the first online visit.

### 3 Create your first season

Choose a season name, the Christmas date, and an optional budget. You can also pick a theme and currency. Nothing is created until you submit the form.

To explore first, tick **"Load the optional sample season"**. The sample is clearly flagged and can be removed later without touching real records.

### 4 Add people, then gifts

Add recipients with an optional spending cap, then add gifts with a planned budget and optional store, link, address, and notes. Mark a gift bought when you pay for it; wrapped and sent follow in any order you need.

Use the **Idea Bank** for possibilities, the **Shopping List** for what is still unbought, and **Seasons & archives** for backups and exports.

## Everyday safety habits

- **Download a backup after big changes** and before clearing browser data, changing devices, or resetting the planner.
- **Keep backups private.** A complete backup includes delivery addresses and notes so it can actually restore your data.
- **Restore replaces everything.** Download the current data first; the app requires that before it enables restoring.
- **Ask the browser to keep your data.** In **Settings > Storage health**, choose **Request persistent storage**. A grant is not a guarantee; backups remain essential.
- **Use the same browser profile.** Data does not move between browsers or devices unless you export a backup and restore it.

## Quick answers

| | |
|---|---|
| **Does it need an account?** | No. This offline edition has no sign-in, account, or cloud sync. |
| **Does it work offline?** | Yes, after one online visit and after the app has saved its files. Install is optional but recommended. |
| **Where is my data?** | In this browser's local storage on this device. Backups are the portable copy. |
| **Can I use it on my phone?** | The layout is responsive and tested at 360-390 px. Safari on iPhone/iPad is not yet verified; keep backups if you use it there. |
| **Does it convert currency?** | No. Currency changes how amounts are displayed; it never converts or rewrites saved values. |
| **Can I export to a spreadsheet?** | Yes. CSV export is available for the active season or all seasons, with addresses and notes off by default. |

## If something goes wrong

Open the *User Guide* troubleshooting section first. It covers offline launch problems, storage messages, missing data after switching browsers, and the missing install option. If you still need help, contact the seller through **Etsy Messages** and include:

- the app version (shown in Settings and the sidebar: 1.0.0),
- your browser and device,
- what you clicked, what you expected, and what happened,
- a screenshot of the message, if there is one.

Christmas Gift Tracker 1.0.0 | Offline edition | Start Here | 31 October 2026. This app is an independent product and is not affiliated with Etsy or any browser maker.